

/mnt

All storage media other than Linux partitions are “mounted” here. (The concept of mounting is explained in the next sections). Each device has a folder created for it, for example, the CD-ROM and the floppy drive. Windows drives/partitions too are mounted here. (A FAT file system is seen as a Windows drive). To access these devices, you need to get to the `/mnt` directory and open the appropriate device there. There can be a shortcut to the devices on your desktop or elsewhere, depending on the Linux you have, but then these shortcuts will access the devices mounted in this folder.

/opt

The “options” directory stores add-on components such as desktop environments, databases (such as Oracle), etc. A crude analogy would be the Program Files in Windows.

/tmp

This one is simple, isn’t it? As the name suggests, this is the temporary directory that the system uses for various purposes that we, as end users, need not be too worried about.

/usr

Non-critical system files are stored in this directory, which contains a copy of most of the directories in the root—you’ll find here a “bin” directory containing programs, a “lib” directory containing libraries, etc. Generally, important or core Linux files are contained in the root directories, while others are put in the `/usr` subdirectories.

/var

The *various* folder contains just that—various files such as log files, spools, etc.